SDC GUIDE TO ENGINEERING ISSUES

Version	Author	Date Amended	Revision Date	Changes Made	Approved By	Comments
1.0	Joshua Devlin (Operations Director)	06/01/2025	06/07/2025	Initial draft	Lee Mutch (Engineering Director)	Amendments required
1.1	Joshua Devlin (Operations Director)	13/01/2025	13/07/2025	Updated to enhance instruction relating to Go-Check	Lee Mutch (Engineering Director)	Minor updates
1.2	Joshua Devlin (Operations Director)	13/01/2025	13/07/2025	Updated to include Red & Amber distinction	Lee Mutch (Engineering Director)	Minor updates
1.3	Joshua Devlin (Operations Director)	26/03/2025	26/10/2025	Correction on amber ABS	Lee Mutch (Engineering Director)	Minor update to process

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Safety Declaration

Safety is Non-Negotiable

The safety of everyone—staff, passengers, and the public—is our highest priority. Any action that compromises this is unacceptable. If a vehicle has a safety-critical defect or risks receiving a PG9 prohibition, it must not remain in service.

Remember: once a prohibition is issued, the vehicle cannot be used unless an exemption is granted. When in doubt, seek advice from a competent engineer.

Balancing Safety and Service Continuity

Minimising customer disruption is essential, but never at the cost of safety. If a bus has non-safety-critical defects, it may temporarily stay in service until a reasonable changeover can occur. However, it's vital to ensure that known defects don't persist for too long, as this can attract DVSA attention and result in damage to our vehicles.

Making Appropriate Decisions

Every situation involving vehicle defects requires careful judgement. While safety takes precedence, decisions should align with DVSA standards and be reasonable.

Guidance for Action

This document provides tools and guidance for addressing common defects. Use it to identify problems, consult drivers, and make informed decisions. For clarity on defect categories, refer to DVSA's 'Categorisation of Defects' and maintain communication with drivers at all times.
Categorisation of vehicle defects - GOV.UK

Road traffic incidents

Check on the Driver’s Wellbeing

If the driver seems distressed or unfit to proceed, reassure them:

“Take a moment to gather yourself. If you’re feeling unwell or unable to continue, let me know so we can arrange support.”

If the driver is unfit to continue, arrange for a supervisor to attend immediately.

Ask About Injuries on the Bus

“Is anyone on the bus injured?”

If injuries are reported:

Confirm: “Have you offered to assist them or seek medical help?”

Follow up: “What response did you get from the injured person?”

Reassure the driver that their role is to assist where possible and remain calm.

Confirm Police Involvement

“Have the police been notified about the incident?”

If not, advise the driver:
“It’s important to notify the police as soon as possible if someone is injured. I can help guide you through this if needed.”

If police attendance is confirmed:
“Do you know if they are coming to the scene? I’ll advise you on the next steps based on their response.”

Assess the Driver’s Condition

“Are you injured in any way? Are you able to continue your duties safely?”

If the driver is injured:
“Let’s get a replacement driver to your location so you can rest and get the care you need.”

Evaluate the Bus Damage
“Can you describe any damage to the bus? Are there any sharp edges, loose parts, or damaged lights?”

If damage is reported, advise the driver to input it into Go-Check and consult a qualified engineering colleague:

They’ll decide whether the bus can:

- Continue in service.
- Return to the depot out of service.
- Remain where it is whilst an engineer attends.

Provide reassurance:
“We’ll get this sorted safely and efficiently. Your priority is to keep yourself and the passengers safe.”

Make an Informed Decision About the Vehicle Following Engineering Advice.

Communicate that decision clearly with the driver.

<u>Guide the Driver Through Follow-Up Actions</u>

- Remind the driver to complete all necessary reports including a tracerit report **within 24 hours**.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System
- Provide Reassurance and Support
- Escalate to senior managers if required
- Report all personal injuries
- If the collision involved a third party vehicle and the driver isn't present advise our driver to leave a bump card

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Broken Windows Guidance

Driver
Is this driver fit and well and able to continue in service?

> **Yes:** Continue to next question
> **No:** Seek medical attention and organise a replacement driver

Passengers
Are all passengers unharmed?

> **Yes:** Continue to next question
> **No:** Seek medical attention

Vehicle
Is the driver's view seriously impaired, or does it present a danger to occupants? Is detachment of loose articles likely?

> **Yes:** Stop immediately and seek assistance from engineering.
>
> **No:** Continue to the next appropriate changeover point. The driver must remain vigilant and stop if the situation changes

- The extent of the damage: Sharp edges, loose parts, damaged lights, etc.
- Consult engineering if you don't believe the vehicle can continue

If the driver disagrees with continuing:

- Advise them to remain where they are.
- Report the situation to the relevant depot management for further investigation.
- Seek depot assistance for a replacement driver.

If the vehicle has been vandalized beyond the windows and brakes, steering, or control systems are affected (including wheels/tyres), the bus must remain stationary.

Additional Guidance:

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Brakes

If any of the following occur, advise the driver to switch off the vehicle and await engineering attendance:

- Brake pedal sinks to the floor with little or no resistance.
- Braking response is delayed or ineffective.
- Unusual noises (e.g., grinding or squealing) during braking.
- Visible leaks in the brake system (e.g., brake fluid).
- Brakes are grabbing or shuddering.
- Red ABS/EBS light is illuminated.

Additional Guidance:

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.
- Vehicles permitted to continue must have a planned changeover organised at the earliest opportunity.
- Report to the depot management team if you feel a particular individual is persistently reporting steering problems that, when investigated by engineering, reveal no fault. This ensures any unnecessary service disruption can be appropriately addressed.

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Steering

If any of the following occur, advise the driver to **switch off the vehicle and await engineering attendance**:

- Excessive play in the steering wheel. The DVSA expects the steering system to have no more than 75mm of play at the rim of a steering wheel for vehicles with power steering.
- Difficulty steering or maintaining control of the vehicle.
- Unusual noises when steering (e.g., knocking, grinding, or squealing).
- Vehicle pulling to one side during operation.
- Visible damage to the steering system (e.g., steering column, linkage).
- Leaks from the power steering system.
- Steering becomes stiff or unresponsive.
- Any warning light related to steering is illuminated.

Additional Guidance:

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.
- Vehicles permitted to continue must have a planned changeover organised at the earliest opportunity.
- Report to the depot management team if you feel a particular individual is persistently reporting steering problems that, when investigated by engineering, reveal no fault. This ensures any unnecessary service disruption can be appropriately addressed.

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Non Starter

If a driver reports a non-starting vehicle, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Initial Troubleshooting

Instruct the driver to complete the following checks:

1. Ensure the vehicle is out of gear and in neutral.
2. Are any lights illuminated or flashing on the gear selector.
3. Turn off all instruments, including the main switch, to reset the bus.
4. Confirm the engine bay door is closed and secure.
5. Turn the vehicle back on and attempt to start the engine.

- **If the vehicle starts**: Advise the driver to continue in service.
- **If the vehicle fails to start**: Proceed to Step 2.

Step 2: Rear Start Attempt

1. Confirm it is safe to attempt a rear start.
2. Advise the driver to exercise caution when attempting a rear start. Ensure that items such as ties and lanyards are either removed or securely placed over the shoulder to prevent entanglement in the belt.
3. If the engine starts, instruct the driver to leave it running until an engineer attends. Arrange a changeover if necessary.
4. If the vehicle still fails to start, proceed to Step 3.

Step 3: Gather Diagnostic Information

Ask the driver the following questions to assist engineers in diagnosing the issue:

- Is the oil light illuminated?
- Was there smoke coming from the exhaust?
- Is the engine trying to start, or is it completely unresponsive?

Additional Guidance:

- Ensure vehicles permitted to continue have a planned changeover organised promptly.
- Escalate persistent, unwarranted non-starter reports to the depot management team to address any unnecessary service disruptions effectively.

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Excessive Smoke

If a driver reports excessive smoke, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Advise the driver to **switch off the vehicle and await engineering attendance** if any of the following apply:

- Fumes are entering the vehicle interior.
- The exhaust is becoming detached.
- Smoke levels are sufficient to obscure vision or create danger for other road users.
- There is a continuous stream of dense blue or clearly visible black smoke.

Additional Guidance:

- Ensure a planned changeover is arranged promptly for vehicles permitted to continue.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.
- Escalate persistent, unwarranted smoke-related reports to the depot management team. This ensures patterns of unnecessary service disruption are addressed appropriately.

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Overheating

If a driver reports an overheating issue, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Check the Temperature Gauge

- **80–100°C**: Advise the driver they can continue to a convenient changeover point.
- **Over 100°C**: Proceed to Step 2.

Step 2: Identify the Cause

- **Low Water**: Determine if the driver can safely reach the next location to top up the water.
- **Overheating**: Proceed to Step 3.

Step 3: Determine if the Water Buzzer is Sounding

- **No Buzzer**: Advise the driver to continue to the next changeover point.
- **Buzzer Sounding**: Proceed to Step 4.

Step 4: Inspect for Water Leaks

- Ask the driver to check for visible signs of water leaks:
    - **NEVER** ask a driver to step into the highway, ensure they stay safe at all times.
    - **Leaks Present**: Advise the driver to stop immediately and await engineering assistance.
    - **No Leaks**: Proceed to Step 5.

Step 5: Mitigate the Issue Using Heaters and Demisters

- Instruct the driver to turn on the heaters and demisters to disperse heat in the system.
    - If this resolves the issue: Advise the driver to continue to the next convenient changeover point.
    - If the problem persists: Instruct the driver to stop and await engineering assistance.

Additional Guidance:

- Vehicles permitted to continue must have a planned changeover organised at the earliest opportunity, record the defect immediately on Go-Check.
- **Never advise drivers to remove the radiator cap.**
- If the driver is uncertain about the safety of continuing, instruct them to stop and await further guidance from engineering.
- Escalate any complex or unresolved situations to the relevant engineering team for further assessment.

Wipers Not Working / Screen Wash

If a driver reports issues with wipers or screen wash, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Key Questions:

1. Is the whole blade or arm missing?
2. Which side of the windscreen is affected?
3. Are the wipers moving at all?
4. Are the windscreen washers inoperative or inadequate?
5. Can you hear the wiper motor whirring?

Actions:

- If the driver's vision is impaired, **advise them to stop immediately and await engineering assistance.**
- If vision is not impaired, assess the urgency of the situation based on:
    - Weather conditions.
    - The route (e.g., long stretches on major roads like A19 or A1M require prioritised changeovers).

Temporary Measures:

- Advise the driver or supervisor to clean the windscreen at a safe location if conditions allow.
- Arrange for the washer system to be topped up at a convenient location, if necessary.

Additional Guidance:

- Ensure a planned changeover is arranged promptly for vehicles permitted to continue.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.
- Escalate persistent, unwarranted wiper-related reports to the depot management team. This ensures patterns of unnecessary service disruption are addressed appropriately.

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Battery Light On

If the battery light is on, follow these steps to assess the situation and determine the next course of action:

Step 1: Check Belts

- **ALWAYS** advise the driver to steer clear of moving belts and turn the engine off before inspection.
- **Belts in place:** Proceed to Step 2.
- **Belt(s) come off:**
    - **Wait for engineering assistance.**
    - If no other warning lights (e.g., temperature warning) are on, the vehicle may be moved a short distance if needed for safety.

Step 2: Check Master Switch

- **Master switch not engaged:**
    - **Engage the master switch** and continue.
- **Master switch engaged:**
    - **Wait for engineering assistance** as there is a possibility that they transmission drive may be lost, and other electrical components may fail.

Additional Guidance:

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Escalate persistent, battery issues to the engineering management team. This ensures patterns of unnecessary service disruption are addressed appropriately.

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ABS Light On

If the ABS light comes on, follow these steps to assess the situation and determine the appropriate course of action:

AMBER ABS

Step 1: Stop

- The driver should **stop and shut down the vehicle, performing a full reset.**

Step 2a: Amber ABS light is no longer illuminated (once the vehicle achieves 10mph)

- The vehicle may remain in service, but the defect should be logged on Go-Check. If the light reappears seek further advice.

Step 2b: Amber ABS light remains illuminated (once the vehicle achieves 10mph)

- The vehicle may remain in service, but changeover at the earliest convenience.

Additional Guidance:

RED ABS

Step 1: Stop

- The driver should **stop and shut down the vehicle, performing a full reset.**

Step 2a: Red ABS light is no longer illuminated (once the vehicle achieves 10mph)

- The vehicle may remain in service, but changeover at the earliest convenience.

Step 2b: Red ABS light remains illuminated (once the vehicle achieves 10mph)

- The driver should **stop and wait for engineering assistance**.

Additional Guidance:

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System.
- Safety is the priority. Any light regarding an ABS fault must be checked over by an engineer.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.

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Demisters / Heaters Not Working

If the demisters or heaters are not working, assess the situation based on whether the driver's vision is affected.

Step 1: Check if the Demisters are Blowing

- **Not blowing at all:**
  - Advise the driver to take the bus to the nearest changeover point or continue until a replacement becomes available, only if visibility is not impaired.
  - Ask the driver to check for blockages (e.g., bags, newspapers, etc.) if the demisters are blowing but not effectively.
- **Blowing cold air only:** Proceed to Step 2.

Step 2: Check the Saloon Temperature

- **16 degrees or above:**
  - Advise the driver to continue in service until a replacement vehicle becomes available, but a changeover is not urgent.
- **Below 16 degrees:**
  - The vehicle should be changed over as soon as possible.

Additional Guidance:

- Ensure the vehicle has had adequate time to warm up, typically after at least 1 hour in service.
- **The driver's vision is the priority.** If it is affected, the vehicle should not continue in service.
- In the case of a cold bus, if the vehicle cannot be changed over immediately, check with engineering at least once an hour to ascertain when the vehicle can be changed and inform the driver accordingly.
- If the situation is unreasonable, report it to the relevant Depot Manager for further investigation.

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Low Water

If a driver reports a low water issue, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Check for Leaks

- **No leaks present:** Proceed to Step 2.
- **Leak found:**
    - Assess if the bus can safely reach the next convenient changeover point.
    - If it is a short distance away, advise the driver to continue.
    - If not, seek advice from engineering.

Step 2: Is the Water Buzzer Sounding?

- **No:** Advise the driver to continue to the next convenient changeover point.
- **Yes:** Proceed to Step 3.

Step 3: Confirm Recent Water Top-Up (if applicable)

- **Recently filled at the depot:**
    - Arrange for a top-up en route by authorised staff to see if the issue is resolved.
- **Filled a long time ago or driver unsure:**
    - Use the SDC top up log to verify this.
    - Arrange a top-up en route if feasible.
    - If not feasible, seek advice from engineering.
    - In the case of a second top up, a changeover should be arranged at the earliest opportunity.

Step 4: If the Top-Up Does Not Resolve the Issue

- Arrange for the bus to continue in service temporarily and schedule a changeover at the nearest suitable location.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Doors Not Working

If a driver reports an issue with the doors, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Initial Checks

- **Door Control Buttons:**
  - Ask the driver to check if any of the door control buttons are stuck (both inside and outside the bus).
- **Obstructions:**
  - Confirm there are no obstructions behind or under the doors.

Step 2: Air System Check

- **Listen for Air Leaks:**
  - Instruct the driver to check for air leaks.
- **Check Air Pressure:**
  - Ask the driver to monitor the air pressure and try to build it up to see if this resolves the issue.

Step 3: Escalation

If the above steps do not resolve the issue, proceed to the assessment below.

STOP and Seek Engineering Assistance if Any of the Following Defects Are Present:

- Doors are jammed closed.
- Doors cannot be retained in the closed position.
- Door hinges, catches, or pillars are loose, insecure, weakened, or make the doors difficult to shut or likely to open inadvertently.
- Doors are stiff and cannot fully open or close.

If None of the Above Defects Are Present:

- Advise the driver to continue in service and proceed to the next convenient location for a bus changeover.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Cut Out or Fuel Problem

If a driver reports a cut-out or fuel issue, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Check the Ignition

- Confirm that the ignition is turned on.

Step 2: Inspect for Fuel Leaks

- If a driver suspects a fuel leak, they should visually inspect around the bus when in a safe location to do so, paying attention to fuel tanks, hoses, and under the vehicle.
- Drivers should check for a strong smell of diesel, wet patches, or visible drips.
- **Fuel Leak Identified:**
  - Stop the bus as soon as it is safe.
  - Turn off the engine to reduce fire risk.
  - Do not start or drive the bus again.
  - Off-board passengers.
  - Await engineering assistance.
  - If fuel is pooling, drivers should use spill kits (if available) or sand to prevent spreading.
  - If the leak is severe, fire services may be required to assist with spill containment.
  - If a bus stop or roadway is affected, SDC should notify local authorities to arrange clean-up.
- No Fuel Leak:
  - Proceed to Step 3.

Step 3: Assess the Situation

- **First-Time Occurrence:**
  - Advise the driver to continue to a convenient changeover point.
- **Persistent Problem:**
  - If the vehicle continues to cut out after initial contact, instruct the driver to STOP in a safe location and await engineering assistance.

Additional Guidance:

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.
- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.

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Ramp Stuck Out

If a driver reports that the ramp is stuck out, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Reset the Vehicle

- Instruct the driver to switch off the ignition and re-set the vehicle.
- If this clears the issue, advise the driver to continue in service.
- If the problem persists, proceed to Step 2.

Step 2: Assess Driver Training for Manual Retraction

- **Not Risk Assessed for Manual Retraction:**
  - Advise the driver to STOP and await assistance from engineering.
  - Note: Being trained to use manual ramps is not the same as being risk assessed to manually retract a stuck ramp.
- **Risk Assessed for Manual Retraction:**
  - Instruct the driver to attempt retracting the ramp manually using the method they were trained on.

Step 3: If the Problem Persists

- Instruct the driver to **stop and await assistance from engineering**.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Gearbox Temperature

If a driver reports a gearbox temperature issue, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Reset the Vehicle

- Instruct the driver to switch off the bus and re-set it.
- If this clears the issue, advise the driver to continue in service.
- If the problem persists, proceed to Step 2.

Step 2: Check for Coolant Leaks

- Ask the driver to check for visible signs of water leaks:
    - **NEVER** ask a driver to step into the road, ensure they always stay safe.
    - **Leaks Present**: Advise the driver to stop immediately and await engineering assistance.
    - **No Leaks**: Proceed to Step 3.

Step 2: Assess the Terrain

- **Hilly Terrain Just Operated:**
    - Advise the driver to continue in service for a short time to monitor if the issue persists.
    - Arrange for a changeover at the next convenient location.
- **No Hilly Terrain Operated:**
    - Assess whether the bus can safely reach the nearest changeover point.

Step 3: Evaluate Risk

- If the changeover point is too far to safely drive the bus **stop and await assistance from engineering.**

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Oil Warning Light On

If a driver reports an oil warning light issue, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Instruct the Driver to Stop Immediately

- Ensure the vehicle is stopped in a safe location.

Step 2: Check for Oil Leaks

- Ask the driver to inspect for visible oil leaks:
  - **If a Leak is Visible:**
    - The vehicle must **remain STOPPED** with the engine switched off.
    - Await assistance from engineering.
  - **If No Leak is Visible continue to Step 3.**

Step 3: Light Status While Moving

- **Oil Warning Light On or Intermittent:**
  - Instruct the driver to STOP immediately and seek assistance from engineering.

Additional Guidance:

- **Safety First:** Ensure the driver stops immediately if there is any doubt about the severity of the issue. Record the defect immediately on Go-Check.
- **Fire or Hazard Risk:**
  - If the oil leak or spillage poses a potential fire risk or hazard to other road users, escalate the issue immediately as a PG9 (Prohibition Notice) may be issued.
- **Service Continuity:** Coordinate with engineering to arrange for a replacement vehicle promptly to minimise service disruption.

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Repeat Defects

If a driver reports a defect on a bus that has already been identified earlier or persists over multiple days, follow these steps to ensure proper escalation and resolution:

Step 1: Same-Day Repeat Defects

- If a bus is taken out of service due to defects and later reallocated with the same unresolved defects:
    - **Action:** Report the issue immediately to the Engineering Delivery Director.
    - **Notification:** Ensure copies of the report are sent to the General Manager and Engineering Manager.

Step 2: Multi-Day Repeat Defects

- If a bus continues to operate over several days with the same unresolved reported defects:
    - **Action:** Report the issue immediately to the Engineering Delivery Director.
    - **Notification:** Ensure copies of the report are sent to the General Manager and Engineering Manager.

Additional Guidance:

- **Report Accurately:** Report in Go-Check immediately, include pictures if appropriate.
- **Escalation:** Ensure timely communication with engineering and management to prevent service reliability issues and ensure vehicles are roadworthy.
- **Documentation:** Maintain accurate records of all reported defects are documented
- **Safety First:** Prioritise addressing defects that could compromise the safety of passengers, drivers, or other road users.

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Unable to Select Gears

If a driver reports an issue with gear selection, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Attempt a System Reset

- Instruct the driver to switch the bus off and re-set it, then attempt to start up in the usual manner.

Step 2: Check Ramp is Correctly Stowed

- Ask the driver to visually inspect if the ramp is correctly secured in its stowed position. The driver should lift the ramp and stow it again to ensure it is correctly secured.

Step 2: Check Suspension Light (if applicable)

- Ask the driver if the suspension light on the dashboard has been re-set before attempting to engage gear.

Step 3: Confirm Proper Operation

- Ensure the driver is pressing firmly on the footbrake while selecting the appropriate gear.

Step 4: Escalate if Unresolved

- If none of the above steps resolve the problem **stop and await assistance from engineering.**

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Warning Lights On

If a driver reports multiple warning lights illuminated, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Identify the Warning Lights

- Ask the driver to describe the illuminated lights:
  - **Fault Type:** What do the lights refer to?
  - **Location:** Where are they on the dashboard?
  - **Colour:** Are the lights RED or AMBER?
  - **Upload:** Ensure an image of the light is uploaded to Go-Check.

Step 2: Respond Based on Light Colour

- **RED Warning Light:**
  - **Action (Continuous):** Instruct the driver to **stop and await assistance from engineering.**
  - **Action (Intermittent):** Advise the driver to stop in a safe location and observe whether the light remains off after restarting the vehicle. If the light persists or reappears, seek assistance from Engineering. If it does not, continue to the next safe changeover point, **stop and await assistance from engineering.**
  - **Directional Control:** If a safety critical defect or system is impacted that could affect the control or directional stability of the vehicle, **stop and await assistance from engineering.**
- **AMBER Warning Light:**
  - **Action:** Advise the driver to continue to the next convenient changeover point, if the light is ABS follow the guidance in section 3 – ABS light.

Step 3: Escalate if Uncertain

- **If in doubt stop and await assistance from engineering.**

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Various Buzzers Sounding

If a driver reports any buzzing sound from the vehicle, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Identify the Buzzer

- **Which buzzer is sounding?**
  Ask the driver to identify which specific buzzer is sounding and whether it's consistent or intermittent.

Step 2: Check for Warning Lights

- **Are any warning lights illuminated?**
  Ask the driver to check the dashboard for any illuminated warning lights that may correspond with the buzzer sound.

Step 3: Refer to SDC Guide (if applicable)

- **Consult this guide (if applicable):**
  If any buzzers referenced in this guide are shown, refer to the guidance given and determine whether it is safe to continue to the next convenient changeover point.

Step 4: Refer to the Dashboard Manual (if available)

- **Consult the manual (if available):**
  Check the dashboard manual to determine what the buzzer indicates and assess whether it is safe to continue to the next convenient changeover point.

Note: Some vehicles will not drive with a buzzer sounding, in this case **stop and await assistance from engineering.**

Step 5: Take Action

- If the issue cannot be resolved by the above steps:
  Instruct the driver to **stop and await assistance from engineering**.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Damage to Wing Mirror

If a driver reports damage to a wing mirror, follow these steps to assess and respond appropriately:

Step 1: Assess the Extent of the Damage

- **Is it only the glass, or both the glass and arm damaged?**
  - If the damage is only to the glass, assess whether the driver can continue using the mirror satisfactorily.
  - **Driver can continue using the mirror satisfactorily:** Advise the driver to continue to the nearest convenient relief point.
  - **Driver cannot continue using the mirror satisfactorily:** Instruct the driver to **stop and await assistance from engineering**

Step 2: Determine Which Side of the Vehicle the Damage is On

- **Which side of the vehicle is it?**
  - If the damage is to the **nearside** mirror, it may be less critical, but the decision should still be made by the driver based on their comfort and safety.
  - If the damage is to the **offside** mirror, it may pose a higher risk, especially regarding visibility and safe driving. In this case, the driver should **stop and await assistance from engineering.**

Step 3: Check for Additional Damage to the Vehicle

- **Is there any other damage to the bus?**
  If additional damage to the vehicle is present, consider whether it affects the safety or operation of the bus. If so, **stop and await assistance from engineering**.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Loose Wheel Nuts

If a driver reports loose wheel nuts, follow these steps:

1. **STOP immediately**
    - Advise the driver to **stop** the vehicle safely at the earliest opportunity.
2. **Seek assistance from Engineering**
    - Contact Engineering immediately to assess the situation and provide assistance.
3. **Do not allow the vehicle to continue in service**
    - Under no circumstances should the vehicle continue in service with loose wheel nuts.
4. **Report to appropriate management.**
    - Incidents of loose wheel nuts should be reported to the depot engineering manager, general manager and engineering delivery director.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Damage to bus Interior and Exterior

Follow these steps for based on type of damage:

1. **Floor Around the Driver Insecure / Weakened**
    - **Stop and await assistance from engineering** if it affects the driver's control or safety.
    - **Otherwise**, continue to a suitable changeover point.
2. **Driver's Seat Loose**
    - **Stop and await assistance from engineering** if it is so loose or weakened that it could cause the driver to lose control of the vehicle.
    - **Otherwise**, continue to a suitable changeover point.
3. **Rear View Mirror and/or Glass Missing/Insecure/Damaged**
    - **Continue** to the nearest suitable changeover point.
4. **Horn Missing/Insecure/Inoperative**
    - **Continue** to the nearest suitable changeover point.
5. **Passenger Seats Insecure**
    - **Stop and await assistance from engineering** if the seat is likely to become displaced and can't be secured.
        - Driver may try to secure the seat, and if successful, **continue** to the next suitable changeover point and arrange a change within 1 hour.
        - If the seat damage is likely to cause injury or damage clothing, **secure the area** if possible.
        - If it can't be secured, the driver should **Stop and await assistance from engineering** and seek assistance from Engineering.
6. **Body Panels - Exterior Damaged/Missing/Protruding/Insecure/Corroded**
    - **Stop and await assistance from engineering** if the damage is likely to become detached, protrude into the road, or cause injury.
    - **If it can be secured**, continue to the next convenient changeover point.
7. **Interior Side Panel - Damaged/Missing/Protruding/Insecure**
    - **Stop and await assistance from engineering** if the damage is likely to become detached or cause injury.
    - **Otherwise**, secure the panel and continue to the next changeover point.
8. **Bumper Bar Insecure/Damaged**
    - **Stop and await assistance from engineering** if detachment is likely, either partially or completely, or if the bumper has projections or jagged edges likely to cause injury.
    - **If it can be secured**, the driver should attempt to secure it and continue to the next changeover point.
9. **Registration Plate Missing/Incomplete/Insecure/Faded/Obscured**
    - Record the issue on Go-Check, the vehicle can continue in service.
    - However, the plate should be replaced and repaired when possible, and a changeover should be arranged as soon as feasible.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.

- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Speedo Not Working

Steps to follow:

1. **Check if the Tacho Head is Closed** (if the vehicle is fitted with a tachograph).
    - If the tacho head is closed, continue to next step.
    - If the vehicle does not have a tachograph, **arrange a changeover** at the next convenient location and time, within a reasonable time frame.
        - **Reasonable** means arranging a changeover at the earliest opportunity, avoiding any unnecessary delay or loss of mileage.
        - If the vehicle is going a considerable distance before passing an established changeover point, plan to change the vehicle at a convenient point en-route.
        - If the driver must continue without a functioning speedometer to reach the changeover point, they should be instructed to **drive with extreme caution** and ensure they do not exceed any speed limits.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Puncture

1. **Determine the Position of the Puncture:**
    - Identify whether it is an inner or outer tire.
    - Determine whether it is on the rear or front, and which side (offside or nearside).
2. **Driver Action:**
    - The driver should **stop** immediately and **seek advice from engineering** after providing the above information.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.
- Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Interior Lights

The vehicle may continue in service if the following conditions are met, but **change the bus over** at the **earliest opportunity**, especially if operating during darkness.

1. **Are at least 50% of the lights on each deck illuminated?** (i.e., at least one side of the lights working).
2. **Is the step light working when the doors are open?**

- **If the answer to both questions is "yes,"** the bus can continue in service, but a **changeover** should still be arranged as soon as possible.
- **If the answer to either question is "no,"** arrange for the bus to be **changed over immediately**.

Additional Guidance:

- Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.
- If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.
- Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.
- Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.

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Suspension

If a driver reports a suspension fault ask the following:

1. Are there any warning lights relating to suspension on the dashboard? Are they red or amber
2. Does the bus lean to one side or another, or is one corner of the bus riding low or high?
3. Prior to the issue, was there an audible bang or loud escape of air?
4. Is the air pressure within normal parameters or does the vehicle fail to build or hold air pressure?
5. Is the ride quality acceptable or has the driver reported an excessively hard or soft ride?
6. Safety is the priority. If the driver has any concerns about continuing, escalate the issue to engineering immediately.

Step 1: Reset the Vehicle

• Instruct the driver to switch off the ignition and re-set the vehicle.

• If this clears the issue, advise the driver to continue in service.

Step 2: If the problem persists

- Instruct the driver to stop and await assistance from engineering.

Additional Guidance:

• If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.

• Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.

• Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.

• Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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Exterior lights

Headlights:

If a driver reports a headlight out (or less than 50% illuminated in an LED unit), take the following actions.

1. Is the vehicle operating in hours of darkness on an unrestricted road?

If yes, the vehicle must not continue, if no, the bus can continue but a changeover arranged before hours of darkness.

Indicators:

If a driver reports a direction indicator (or side repeater) not working, advise the driver to stop and await engineering attendance.

Brake lights:

If a report is made of a defective brake light or lights, ask the following:

1. Is it a low level brake light?
2. Are the brake lights on constantly?
3. Is one or both lights inoperative?

If both low level brake lights are not working or are on constantly advise the driver to stop and await engineering attendance. If one brake light is not working, advise the driver to continue in service and proceed to the next convenient location for a bus changeover.

Additional Guidance:

• If the vehicle can safely continue, ensure a changeover is arranged at the earliest opportunity.

• Ensure that all actions, including top-ups and changeovers, are communicated to the driver promptly.

• Monitor the situation and provide updates to the driver as needed.

• Record any defects immediately on the Go-Check System when the bus is stationary and in a safe location.

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